

Organizational Units (OU), User Management and Group Policy Configuration

After configuring Active Directory Domain Services, Organizational Units (OUs), user accounts, and Group Policy Objects (GPOs) were created to organize departmental resources, enforce security policies, and standardize the user environment across the enterprise infrastructure.

1. Organizational Unit (OU) Creation

Department-based Organizational Units were created to logically separate users and policies within the Active Directory domain.

Configuration Procedure

1. Open **Server Manager**.
2. Navigate to **Tools** → **Active Directory Users and Computers**.
3. Right-click the domain:

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4. Select **New** → **Organizational Unit**.
5. Create the following departmental OUs:

- MGMT OU
- FIN OU
- HR OU
- IT OU

Result

Departmental Organizational Units were successfully created within the domain.

2. Sub-OU Creation

To separate management and standard users, sub-OUs were created under each departmental OU.

Configuration Procedure

1. Right-click departmental OU.
 2. Select **New** → **Organizational Unit**.
 3. Create two sub-OUs under each department:
- Department-Managers
 - Department-Users

Example:

- FIN-Managers
- FIN-Users
- HR-Managers
- HR-Users
- IT-Managers
- IT-Users
- MGMT-Managers
- MGMT-Users

Result

Manager and User sub-OU's were successfully created for all departments.

3. User Account Creation

User accounts were created within their respective departmental sub-OU's.

Configuration Procedure

1. Open **Active Directory Users and Computers**.
2. Navigate to the required sub-OU.
3. Right-click and select **New → User**.
4. Enter user information.
5. Configure password settings.
6. Complete account creation.

Sample User Accounts

OU	User Account
IT-Managers	itadmin
IT-Users	ituser1
FIN-Managers	finadmin
FIN-Users	finuser1
HR-Managers	hradmin
HR-Users	hruser1
MGMT-Managers	mgmtadmin
MGMT-Users	mgmtuser1

Result

Departmental user accounts were successfully created and organized within their respective Organizational Units.

Group Policy Configuration

Group Policies were configured to enforce security standards and standardize the user environment across the domain.

1. USB Block Policy Configuration

A Group Policy Object (GPO) was created to block access to removable storage devices.

GPO Information

Parameter	Value
GPO Name	USB Block
Linked OUs	HR OU, FIN OU
Purpose	Block USB and removable storage access

Configuration Procedure

1. Open **Group Policy Management**.
2. Right-click **Group Policy Objects**.
3. Select **New**.
4. Create GPO:

USB Block

5. Edit the GPO.
6. Navigate to:

Computer Configuration
→ Administrative Templates
→ System
→ Removable Storage Access

7. Enable policy:

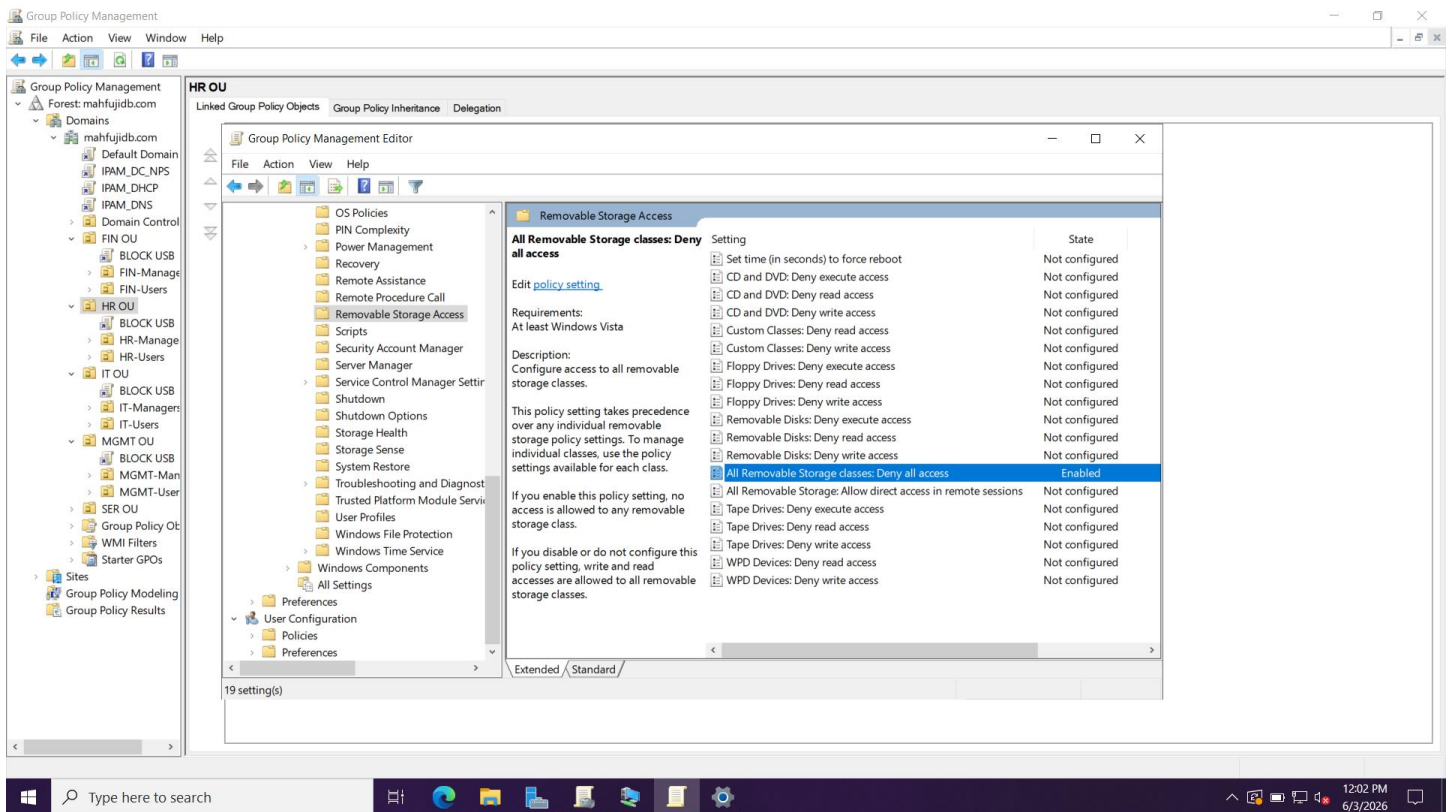
All Removable Storage Classes: Deny All Access

8. Link the GPO to:

- HR OU
- FIN OU

Result

USB storage devices were successfully blocked for users within the HR and Finance Organizational Units.



2. Desktop Wallpaper Policy Configuration

A wallpaper policy was configured through Group Policy to provide a standardized desktop background for all domain users.

Wallpaper Information

Parameter	Value
Wallpaper File	SAMPLE1.png
Shared Location	\\192.168.1.10\wallpaper\SAMPLE1.png

Configuration Procedure

1. Open **Group Policy Management**.
2. Edit **Default Domain Policy**.
3. Navigate to:

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User Configuration
→ Policies
→ Administrative Templates
→ Desktop
→ Desktop
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4. Open **Desktop Wallpaper**.

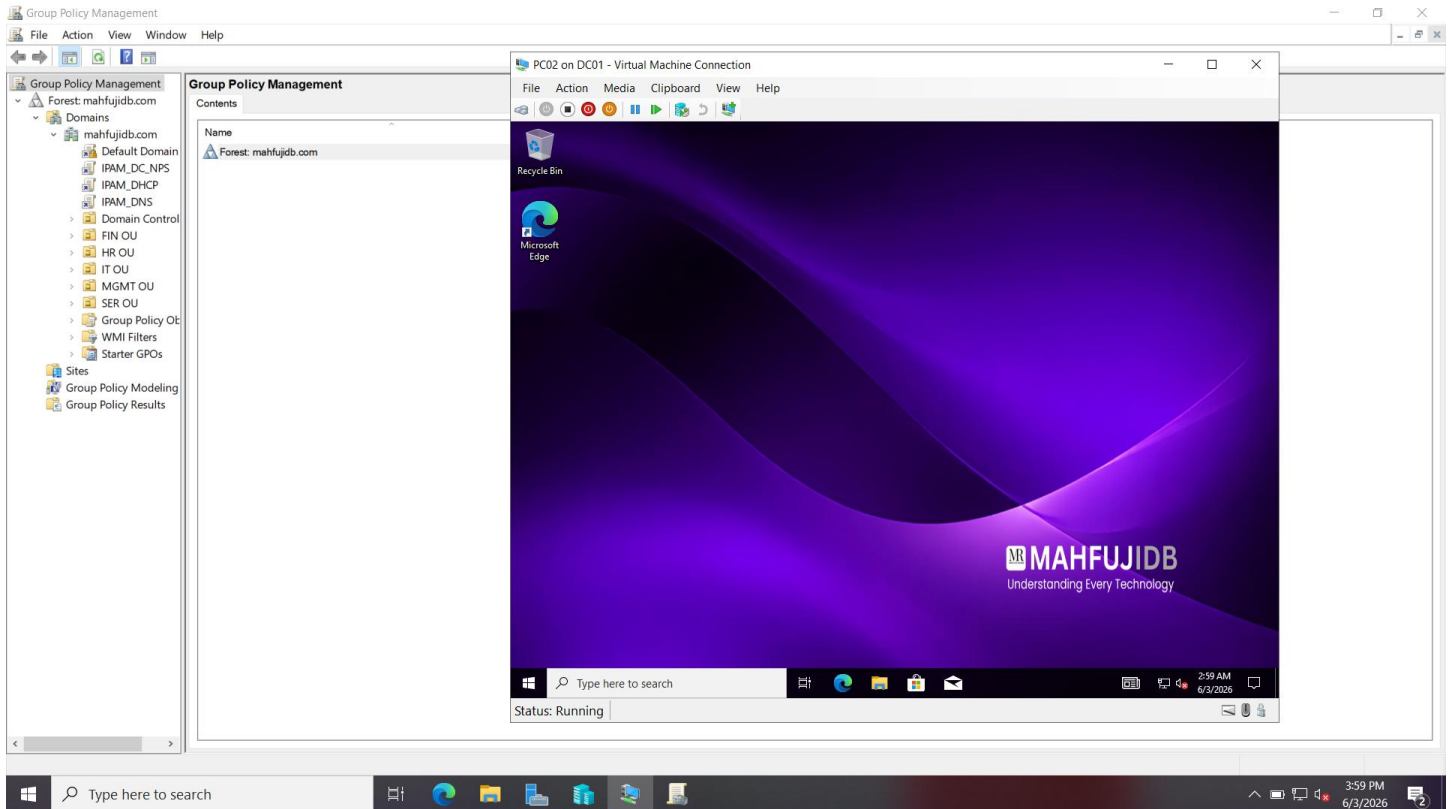
5. Enable the policy.
6. Specify wallpaper path:

\\192.168.1.10\wallpaper\SAMPLE1.png

7. Select Stretch.
8. Apply and save the policy.

Result

A standardized desktop wallpaper was successfully deployed to domain users.



3. Password Policy Configuration

Password policies were configured to strengthen account security across the domain.

Configuration Procedure

1. Open **Group Policy Management**.
2. Edit **Default Domain Policy**.
3. Navigate to:

Computer Configuration
→ Policies
→ Windows Settings

- Security Settings
- Account Policies
- Password Policy

4. Configure the following settings.

Password Policy Settings

Setting	Value
Minimum Password Length	10 Characters
Maximum Password Age	90 Days
Password Complexity	Enabled

Result

Password security requirements were successfully enforced across the domain.

4. Account Lockout Policy Configuration

Account lockout settings were configured to help protect against unauthorized access attempts.

Configuration Procedure

1. Open **Default Domain Policy**.
2. Navigate to:

- Computer Configuration
- Policies
- Windows Settings
- Security Settings
- Account Policies
- Account Lockout Policy

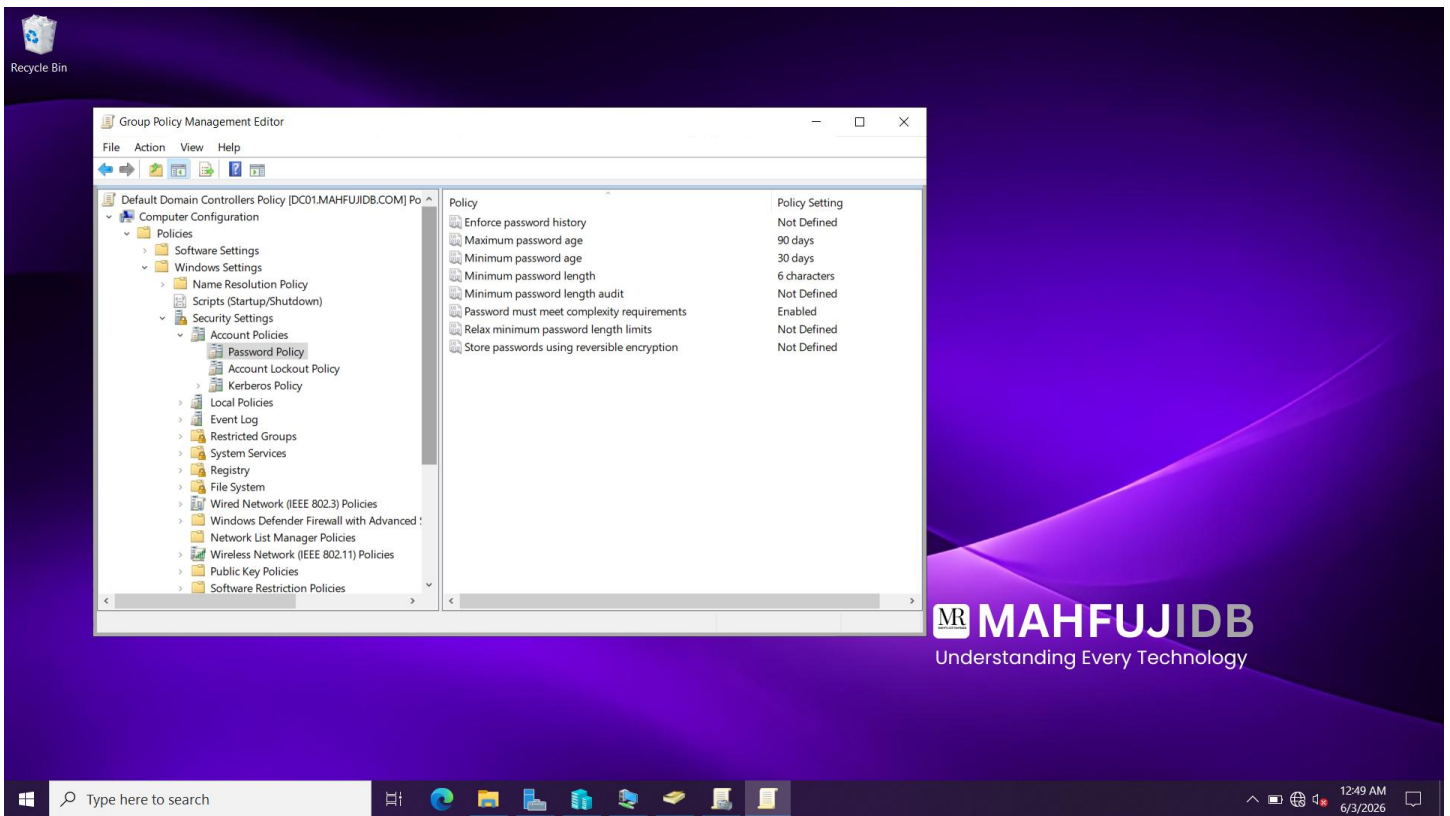
3. Configure the following settings.

Account Lockout Settings

Setting	Value
Account Lockout Threshold	5 Invalid Attempts
Account Lockout Duration	15 Minutes
Reset Account Lockout Counter After	15 Minutes

Result

Account lockout protection was successfully implemented across the domain.



Final Result

The Active Directory environment was successfully organized and secured through:

- Departmental Organizational Units (OUs)
- Manager and User sub-OUs
- Department-based user account management
- USB device restriction policies
- Standardized desktop wallpaper deployment
- Domain password policy enforcement
- Account lockout protection policies

This configuration provides a structured, secure, and centrally managed Active Directory environment.